

feelings of shame, or of having let yourself or others down because of money issues, it's not likely that you're feeling particularly kind towards yourself, or especially inclined to invest in your own wellbeing. The fact that this is, arguably, the most important time to do it, feels like a cruel irony – as so much about the way that money functions in our society does.

The provision for talking therapy on the NHS is subject to much attention, and the privilege discourse around having a therapist is not going away any time soon. I wrote about this for *Grazia* in early 2021,⁹ and when I asked for opinions and experiences, there were an overwhelming number of people wanting to discuss their ordeals – the impossible decisions, the year-long waiting lists, the debt they took on in order to save their mental health.

According to Jo Love, though, there are some avenues for free or affordable therapy that aren't always obvious. Here's her list of avenues that you could explore, if you feel that talking to someone about your relationship with money, and any underlying issues that you might have unearthed, might be good for you, but you feel that cost is a barrier:

1. NHS (speak to your GP, or you can self-refer in most areas online by googling your local Improving Access to Psychological Therapies, or IAPT team).